



China healthcare

EQUITY: HEALTH CARE & PHARMACEUTICALS

National Essential Medicines List (2026 edition) released

Updated after eight years, the latest EML includes more innovative drugs, which augurs well for volume growth

What is new? More than 100 medicines have been added to the EML

On 9 July (noon HKT), the National Health Commission of the People's Republic of China (NHC), National Administration of Traditional Chinese Medicine (NATCM) and National Administration of Disease Control and Prevention (NADCP) jointly *released* the national Essential Medicines List (2026 edition, 2026 EML).

The EML was last updated eight years ago in 2018, and the 2026 edition of the EML will come into effect from 1 September 2026.

The total number of medicines in the 2026 EML has expanded by 109 to 794, which comprises 476 chemical drugs and biologics (68 more) and 318 Chinese medicines (48 more). Therapeutic areas such as diabetes, hypertension, COPD, paediatric illness are given priority, resulting in addition of several medicines.

Our take: The newly updated list will expand usage of included medicines

Encouragingly, we note that several novel drugs (such as GLP-1 RA, monoclonal antibodies for oncology and autoimmune diseases and targeted therapy drugs) have been added, providing more choices for low-tier medical institutions.

In our view, EML inclusion should raise the usage volume of the drugs highlighted below:

CSPC (1093 HK, Buy): NBP (butylphthalide)

Hengrui (600076 CH/1276 HK, Buy): loversol

Innovent (1801 HK, Buy): biosimilars of bevacizumab and adalimumab

Remegen (688331 CH/9995 HK, Neutral): Tai'ai (telitacicept)

Novo Nordisk (NOVO DK, Not rated): semaglutide

AstraZeneca (AZN LN, Not rated): osimertinib, Olaparib, roxadustat

Keymed (2162 HK, Not rated): stapokibart

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Fig. 1: New additions to the 2026 EML

Therapeutic areas	Drug names (in English)	Drug names (in Chinese)
Oncology Drugs	Temozolomide, Bortezomib, Osimertinib, Bevacizumab, Olaparib	替莫唑胺、硼替佐米、奥希替尼、贝伐珠单抗、奥拉帕利
Diagnostic Agents	Ioversol, Gadobutrol	碘佛醇、钆布醇
Nervous System Drugs	Entacapone, Levodopa, Butylphthalide, Edaravone, Dexborneol, Donepezil	恩他卡朋、左乙拉西坦、丁苯酞、依达拉奉右莰醇、多奈哌齐
Psychotropic Drugs	Lurasidone, Sertraline, Dexzopiclone	鲁拉西酮、舍曲林、右佐匹克隆
Immunosuppressive / Immune System Drugs	Tacrolimus, Telitacicept, Adalimumab, Tofacitinib	他克莫司、泰它西普、阿达木单抗、托法替布
Dermatological Drugs	Terbinafine, Stapokibart	特比萘芬、司普奇拜单抗
Anti-infectives	Cefixime, Fusidic Acid, Tenofovir Alafenamide	头孢克肟、夫西地酸、丙酚替诺福韦
Analgesics, Antipyretics, Anti-inflammatory, Antirheumatic, and Antigout Agents	Oxycodone, Loxoprofen Sodium, Flurbiprofen Axetil, Febuxostat	羟考酮、洛索洛芬钠、氟比洛芬酯、非布司他
Cardiovascular Drugs	Trimetazidine, Milrinone, Perindopril tert-Butylamine, Telmisartan, Irbesartan, Ezetimibe	曲美他嗪、米力农、培哚普利叔丁胺、替米沙坦、厄贝沙坦、依折麦布
Digestive System Drugs	Esomeprazole, Rabeprazole, Pancreatin, Polyene Phosphatidylcholine, Combined Bifidobacterium, Lactobacillus, Enterococcus and Bacillus cereus (Live)	艾司奥美拉唑、雷贝拉唑、胰酶、多烯磷脂酰胆碱、双歧杆菌四联活菌
Haematological Drugs	Roxadustat, Cilostazol, Eltrombopag Olamine, Human Granulocyte Colony-Stimulating Factor	罗沙司他、西洛他唑、艾曲泊帕乙醇胺、人粒细胞刺激因子
Hormones and Endocrine Drugs	Somatostatin, Insulin Aspart, Insulin Degludec, Empagliflozin, Semaglutide, Estradiol, Dydrogesterone, Dienogest, Calcium Carbonate with Vitamin D ₃	生长抑素、门冬胰岛素、德谷胰岛素、恩格列净、司美格鲁肽、雌二醇、地屈孕酮、地诺孕素、碳酸钙D ₃

Source: NHC, NATCM, NADCP, Nomura research

Appendix A-1

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